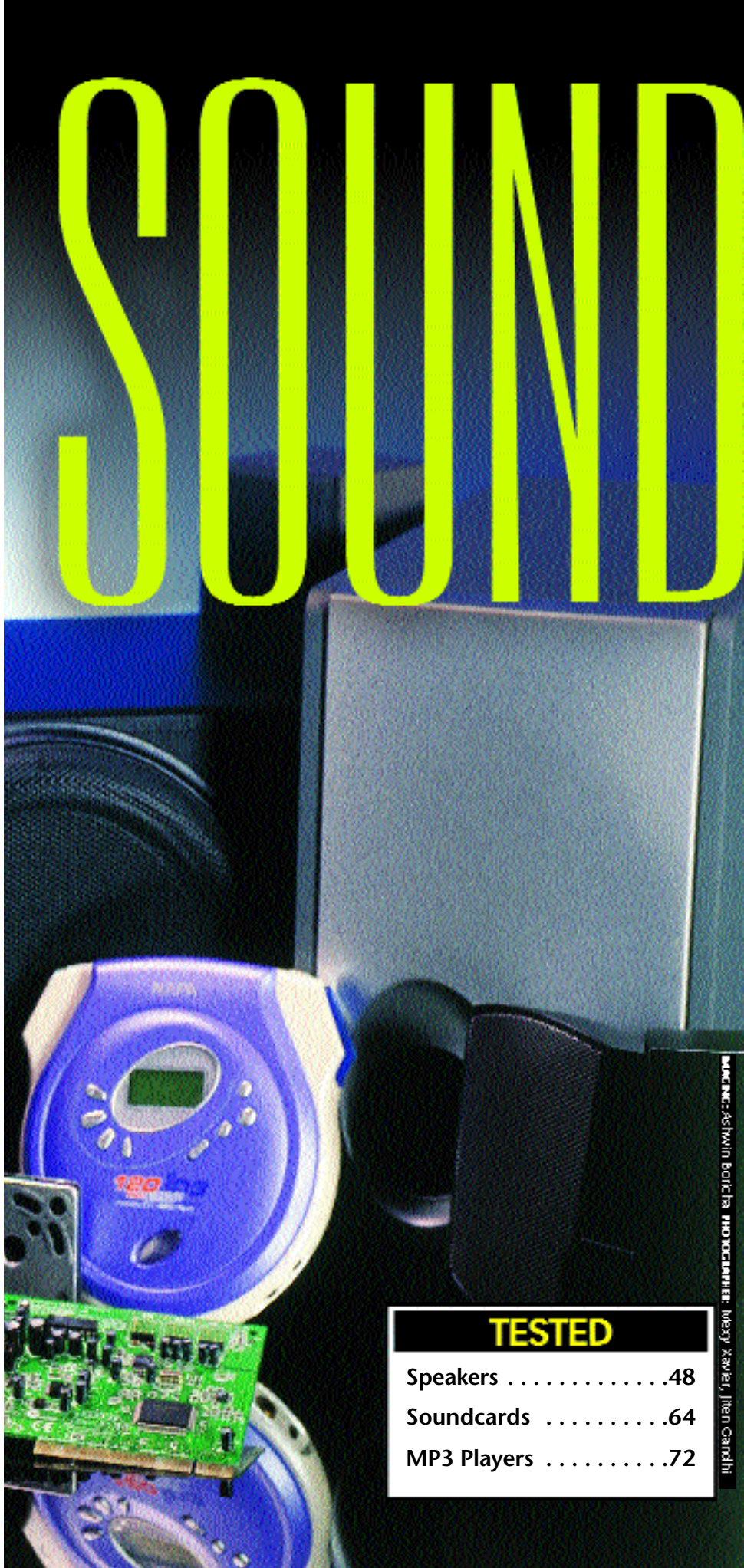


SOUND



No more are we satisfied with sound systems that merely output sound. We now expect a full-blown surround sound experience that lets us feel everything from a room-shaking grenade explosion all the way to the gentlest gush of wind in next-generation games and DVD movies.

Convergence has made it more viable to integrate a home entertainment system within the computer itself, rather than go down the conventional route of buying separate devices for audio and video. With falling prices and increasing availability of these products, we now have a choice from amongst an array of truly utilitarian and sometimes downright funky devices. Today you will find a range of computer speakers that promise acoustic experiences that rival conventional hi-fi systems, affordable MP3 players that let you carry your music wherever you may roam, and soundcards that can transform your computer into a Dolby Digital home theatre system.

The following tests will navigate you through this abundance of audio options to

TESTED

Speakers	48
Soundcards	64
MP3 Players	72

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